

Python Programming

Unit 05 – Lecture 04: Polymorphism (Overriding and Operator Overloading)

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Repository: <https://github.com/tali7c/Python-Programming>

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Learning Outcomes

- Explain polymorphism in OOP

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- Implement method overriding in subclasses

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- Implement method overriding in subclasses
- Implement operator overloading using special methods
- Use `__str__` for readable object printing

Polymorphism (Idea)

- “Same interface, different behavior”

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- Example: `area()` behaves differently for Circle and Rectangle

Method Overriding

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- Python chooses the method based on the object's actual class

Operator Overloading

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 - `+` uses `__add__`
 - `==` uses `__eq__`
 - `len(obj)` uses `__len__`

Example: Point Addition

```
class Point:
    def __init__(self, x, y):
        self.x = x
        self.y = y

    def __add__(self, other):
        return Point(self.x + other.x, self.y + other.y)
```

Demo: Overriding + Operator Overloading

- File: `demo/polymorphism_operator_overloading_demo.py`

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 - polymorphic `area()` calls
 - `Point + Point` using `__add__`

Checkpoint 1

Question: If a parent and child both define `describe()`, which one runs for a child object?

Checkpoint 2

Question: Which special method is used for operator +?

Think-Pair-Share

Discuss:

- Should every class implement operator overloading? When is it helpful vs confusing?

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- Overriding enables polymorphism (same method name, different behavior)
- Operator overloading uses special methods like `__add__`
- Use overloading only when it improves readability and matches meaning

Exit Question

Name the special method used to control printing of an object using `print(obj)`.